MIL-A-12868C(EL)
12 February 1969
SUPERSEDING
MIL-A-12868B(SigC)
21 February 1958
MIL-T-11935(SigC)
15 April 1952

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

ANTENNA SUPPORT AB-105( )/FRC
* TOWER AB-127( )/FR

1. SCOPE

*1.1 This specification covers Antenna Support AB-105( )/FRC and Tower AB-127( )/FR, which are galvanized structural grade steel, guyed, latticed towers with twenty five inch triangular cross section and which have many common components. (See 6.1 and 6.5).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

*2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-M-13231	Marking of Electronic Items
MIL-T-14475	Tower, Antenna AB-127( )/FR, Packaging of
MIL-A-55613	Antenna Support AB-105( )/FRC, Packaging of

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-252	Wired Equipment, Classification of Visual and Mechanical Defects for
MIL-STD-454	Standard General Requirements for Electronic Equipment

FSC 5985

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DRAWINGS

USAECOM

SC-DL-25289	Drawing and Data List, Antenna Support AB-105( )/FRC
SC-DL-27410	Drawing and Data List, Tower AB-127( )/FR
SC-B-83024	Strut (G-8A & G-9A)

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer. Both the title and number or symbol should be stipulated when requesting copies.)

*2.2 Other publications.- The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

Standard A123 Specification for Zinc (Hot-Galvanized) Coatings on Products Fabricated from Rolled, Pressed, and Forged Shapes, Plates, Bars and Strip.

Standard A153 Specification for Zinc Coating (Hot-Dip) on Iron and Steel Hardware.

(Application for copies should be addressed to American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19103.)

AMERICAN WELDING SOCIETY

Code D1.0 Welding in Building Construction

(Application for copies should be addressed to American Welding Society, 345 East 47th Street, New York, N.Y. 10017).

3. REQUIREMENTS

*3.1 Description.- The towers covered by this specification consist of tower sections, steel wire rope guys with turnbuckles, guy anchors, a steel pedestal base (AB-105( )/FRC only), a base insulator (AB-127( )/FR only) and all hardware necessary for assembly. Tower members are fabricated from structrual grade steel strip or sheet, and all components have hot-dipped galvanized finish.

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*3.1.1 Antenna Support AB-105( )/FRC is 73 feet 10 inches in height. This may be increased in increments to 145 feet by constructing a suitable concrete foundation and adding tower sections and guys. Heights of less than 73 feet 10 inches may be obtained by omitting one or more sections, as required.

*3.1.2 Tower AB-127( )/FR is 180 feet in height and requires a suitable concrete foundation.

*3.2 Construction.- The equipment shall be constructed in accordance with the requirements of this specification and of the applicable Drawing and Data List shown below (including the requirements for parts, materials and processes thereon).

Antenna Support AB-105( )/FRC	SC-DL-25289
Tower AB-127( )/FR	SC-DL-27410

*3.3 Preproduction samples.- The contractor shall furnish preproduction samples for approval, if required by the invitation for bids and contract. (See 4.3 and 6.2(d)).

*3.3.1 Fabrication and assembly.- Preproduction samples shall be fabricated by the contractor and shall meet all requirements specified for the equipment on contract. The preproduction samples shall be assembled using parts, materials, and processes that will be employed in production, and shall be fabricated and assembled in a manner similar to that to be used in production.

*3 3.2 Approval and use.- Approval of preproduction samples shall not be construed as a waiver of any specified requirement. After being released to the contractor (see 3.3.3), preproduction samples to be offered as units on contract shall be refabricated by the contractor if necessary to meet specified requirements.

*3.3.3 Reference standards.- After preproduction samples have been approved, they shall be kept intact in custody of the Government inspector until released by him. They shall be used as reference standards to resolve any differences of opinion regarding interpretation of requirements.

*3.4 Materials.- The steel for all formed and welded members shall be in accordance with the requirements of this specification and the documents referenced herein All material shall be free from harmful seams, laminations, piping, blisters and other injurious defects (see 4.6).

*3.5 Fabrication.-

*3.5.1 Bending.- Bending and forming shall be performed in a manner that will insure a full sectional area through each bend. Care shall be exercised to prevent feather or herringbone fracture of the materials on or adjacent to the bending line (see 4.6).

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*3.5.2 Cleaning.- Metal parts, after fabrication, shall be cleaned in accordance with good commercial practice or as specified in an applicable document. Cleaning processes shall have no visible or latent deleterious effect on the equipment (see 4 6)

*3.5 3 Punching.- All holes shall be punched perpendicular to the plane of the material and shall be free from burrs and laminations (see 4.6). Group holes shall be accurately plug gaged (see 4.8.1)

3 5.4 Shearing - All shearing shall be accurate and result in clean edges normal to the plane of the material Burrs or rough edges shall be removed by filing or other approved means before galvanizing (see 4.6).

3.5.5 Straightening - If straightening or flattening is necessary, it will be accomplished by a process or in a manner that will not injure the material. (See 4.6)

*3.5.6 Welding - Welding shall be in accordance with American Welding Society Code D1.0 and shall be such that grinding on the finished weld shall be unnecessary. (See 4.4 and 4.7).

*3.6 Bolt threads.- Thread engagement of all bolts shall be at least three complete threads. Where permitted by design of the equipment, screws and bolts shall extend at least 1-1/2 threads beyond the nuts or equivalent engaging parts. (See 4.8.3).

*3 7 Interchangeability - Like units, assemblies, subassemblies and replaceable parts shall conform to Requirement 7 of MIL-STD-454. (See 4.8)

*3.8 Alignment and parallelism.- Finished members shall be true to line and free from twists, bends and open joints. The heel bend of the corner leg, gage lines and edge of the formed section shall be parallel and accurately conform to the drawing requirements. Each vertical member shall be straight within 3/32 inch per 10 feet of length (see 4.8.2).

*3.9 Assembly.- During assembly it shall be possible to insert bolts by hand with a least three full threads extending beyond material or assembly. Driving of bolts or drifting of holes to effect alignment shall not be allowed (see 4 8.3).

*3.10 Finish, protective.- After all fabrication operations are completed, all members shall be hot dip galvanized in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials Standard A123. Zinc deposits within holes shall be such that they do not prevent the insertion by hand of the appropriate size bolt. All hardware such as nuts and bolts shall be hot dip galvanized in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials Standard A153. (See 4.4 and 4.8.3)

3 11 Marking -

*3.11.1 General.- Marking shall conform to Specification MIL-M-13231 (see 4.4)

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*3.11.2 Visibility.- Wherever practicable, parts shall be so mounted that their identification markings will be readily visible with minimum dissassembly of the equipment.

*3.12 Guy load.- Guys shall be capable of withstanding the minimum tensile load shown by Table I without failure of the cable or insulators or evidence of slipping of the fittings (see 4.9).

* Table I - Guy Minimum Tensile Strength

Guy Type	Tensile Test Load
WR-1-5/8 inch dia. Guy for AB-105( )/FRC	28,100 lb
WR-2-5/16 inch dia. Guy for AB-105( )/FRC	8,000 lb.
Guys No. 1, No. 2, No. 3 and No. 4-3/8 inch dia. Guys for AB-127( )/FR	10,800 lb.
Temporary Guys No. 1 and No. 2-3/16 inch dia. Temporary Guys for AB-127( )/FR	2,850 lb.
(Temporary guy assemblies do not include insulators)	

*3.13 Strut load.- Strut G-8( ), SC-B-83024-1, shall be capable of withstanding a minimum compressive load of 1,700 pounds without evidence of permanent deformation (see 4.10).

*3.14 Tower load.- Sample tower assemblies shall be capable of withstanding the applicable load test, 4.11.1 or 4.11.2, without failure or evidence of permanent deformation.

*3.15 Technical literature, tools and running spare parts.- Technical literature, tools and running spare parts shall be furnished if specified in the contract. Running spare parts shall be identical to corresponding parts in the equipment furnished on the order (see 6.2).

*3.16 Workmanship.- The equipment shall be manufactured and assembled in accordance with requirement 9 of Standard MIL-STD-454 and the applicable portions of the following paragraphs herein.

3.4 Materials
3.5.1 Bending
3.5.2 Cleaning
3.5.3 Punching
3.5.4 Shearing
3.5.5 Straightening
3.5.6 Welding
3.8 Alignment and Parallelism
3.10 Finish, protective
3.11 Marking
3.11.1 General
3.11.2 Visibility

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

*4.1 Responsibility for inspection - Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

*4 2 Classification of inspection - Inspection shall be classified as follows

(a) Preproduction inspection (does not include preparation for delivery). (See 4 3)

(b) Inspection covered by subsidiary documents (See 4 4)

(c) Quality conformance inspection

(1) Quality conformance inspection of equipment before preparation for delivery (See 4.5)

(2) Quality conformance inspection of preparation for delivery. (See 4.12)

*4.3 Preproduction inspection - This inspection shall consist of the inspection specified in the subsidiary documents covering the items listed in 4 4, and the inspection specified for Group A, Group B, and Group C (see Tables II, III and IV, respectively). The preproduction inspection shall be performed in any order which is satisfactory to the procuring agency.

*4 4 Inspection covered by subsidiary documents.- The following shall be inspected under the applicable subsidiary documents as part of the inspection of equipment before preparation for delivery

Item	Where required
Welding	3.5 6
Finish	3.10
Marking	3.11

*4.5 Quality conformance inspection of equipment before preparation for delivery.- The contractor shall perform the inspection specified in 4.4 and 4.5 1 through 4 5.4. This does not relieve the contractor of his responsibility for performing any additional inspection which is necessary to control the quality of the product and to assure compliance with all specification requirements. The Government will review and evaluate the contractor's inspection procedures

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and examine the contractor's inspection records. In addition the Government--at its discretion--may perform all or any part of the specified inspection, to verify the contractor's compliance with specified requirements. (See 6.4) Test equipment for Government verification inspection shall be made available by the contractor.

*4.5.1 Group A Inspection.- Each unit of each lot of equipment shall be inspected for conformance to all the inspection and test requirements of Table II. Each lot will be subjected to verification, utilizing the procedures of Military Standard MIL-STD-105, and the AQL's indicated in Table II. Group A inspection shall be performed in any order which is satisfactory to the Government.

* Table II Group A Inspection

Inspection	Req. Para.	Insp. Para.	AQL	
			Major	Minor
Visual and Mechanical				
Tower Members - Each Component	3.16	4.6	1%	4%
Hardware - Includes bolts, nuts, washers, turnbuckles, anchors, ground rod and clamp, etc.	3.16	4.6	1%	4%
Completed Tower--Quantity and condition	3.2 3.16	4.6	1%	4%

*4.5.2 Group B Inspection.- This inspection, including sampling, shall conform to Table III and to the special procedures for small sample inspection of Standard MIL-STD-105. Group B inspection shall be performed on inspection lots that have passed group A inspection and on samples selected from units that have been subjected to and met the group A inspection. The Special Inspection Plan shall be S-3

Table III Group B Inspection

Inspection	Req Para	Insp Para	AQL
Interchangeability	3.7	4.8	6.5%

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*4.5.3 Group C Inspection.- This inspection shall consist of the tests specified in Table IV and shall be performed on sample units that have been subjected to and met groups A and B inspection. Sample units shall be selected in accordance with paragraph 4.5.3.1.

* Table IV Group C Inspection

Inspection	Req. Para.	Insp. Para
Welding Qualification (AB-105( )/FRC only)	3.5.6	4.7
Load Tests		
Guy Load	3.12	4.9
Strut G-8( ) Load	3.13	4.10
Tower Load	3.14	4.11

*4.5.3.1 Sampling for inspection.

*4 5.3.1.1 Welding qualification inspection.- One welding sample produced by each welder to be employed in fabrication of Antenna Support AB-105( )/FRC shall be subjected to the inspection specified by Table IV.

*4.5.3.1.2 Load tests - One sample antenna support or tower, two guy assembly samples for each diameter guy included in the contract or order, and four samples of Strut G-8( ) shall be selected at random for the inspection specified by Table IV from each 100 antenna supports/towers or fraction thereof produced The first samples selected shall be at the start of the contract from the first quality conformance inspection lot.

*4.5.3 2 Noncompliance.- The contractor shall immediately report in writing each group C failure occurrence, including details of the failure and characteristics affected The contractor shall immediately investigate the cause of failure and further report the results of investigation and details of the proposed corrective action on (i) the process and materials, as applicable, and, (ii) all units of product which were manufactured under the same conditions and which the Government considers subject to the same failure. Reports shall be forwarded to the responsible technical activity designated in the contract through the Quality Assurance Representative After corrective action has been taken, additional sample units shall be subjected to Group C Inspection (all inspections, or the inspections which the sample failed, at the option of the Government) and Groups A and B inspection may be reinstituted, however, final acceptance and shipment will be withheld until the Group C reinspection results have shown that the corrective action was effective.

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*4.5.4 Reinspection of Conforming Group B and Group C Sample Units.- Unless otherwise specified, sample units which have been subjected to and passed both Group B and Group C inspection may be accepted on contract or order provided all damage is repaired and the sample units are resubjected to and pass group A inspection.

*4.6 Visual and mechanical inspection.- Equipment shall be examined for the defects listed in Standard MIL-STD-252 and Table V.

* Table V Classification of Visual and Mechanical Defects

Classification	Defect
Major..	Steel-harmful seams, laminations, piping, blisters or other injurious defects.
	Bending-less than full sectional area through bend, feather or herringbone fracture.
	Cleaning-surface not properly cleaned of rust or foreign matter, residue of cleaning agent left on surface.
	Punching-hole not perpendicular to plane of material, hole burred or laminated.
	Shearing-inaccurate, rough or burred edge, edge not normal to plane of material.
	Straightening or flattening-material injured in process
	Marking-missing, illegible or incorrect
	Parts-missing or improperly assembled
	Item not within requirements of drawing
	Base insulator (AB-127( )/FR only)-cracked, chipped or broken
Minor.....	Scratches, cuts, abrasions, peeling or chipping
	Useless holes or slots

*4 7 Welding qualification Test.- Welders shall be qualified in accordance with American Welding Society Code D1.0. Welding samples shall consist of macroetch and fillet-weld-break specimens in accordance with Option 2 of Article D205 of the Addenda to the Code. (See 3.5.6)

*4.8 Inspection for dimensional interchangeability.- The dimensions listed in 4.8.1, 4.8.2 and 4.8.3 shall be gaged or measured to determine conformance to the physical interchangeability requirements of 3 7 When a listed dimension is not within specified or design limits, it shall be considered a major defect.

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*4 8.1 Hole dimension and accuracy.- The required locations of holes and their dimensions shall be tested for compliance with the accuracy requirements of 3.5.3 before galvanizing. A metal jig or template shall be used. The jig or template may be either the permanent lug type or open hole type. If the open hole type is used, it shall be of such design that it can be placed on the member requiring inspection to permit the insertion of a plug gage having a go section 1/64 inch in diameter larger than the diameter of the bolt to be used. All holes shall be effectively occupied by gages. If the permanent lug type is used, the lugs shall have go sections 1/64 inch in diameter larger than the bolt to be used.

*4.8.2 Alignment and parallelism.- Members shall be measured or gaged to verify that the requirements of 3.8 are met

*4.8.3 Hole clearance.- Tower sections shall be inspected during assembly for Group C test to verify that clearance exists for bolt insertion and that bolts are of sufficient length in accordance with 3.6, 3.9 and 3.10.

4.8.4 Gages.- Testing equipment shall be furnished by the contractor and shall include all gages, jigs, and templates required to test the dimensions and location of holes, angles, thicknesses, and dimensions of materials and formed members to insure that the various parts will fit together as required, and that all corresponding replaceable parts will be mechanically interchangeable in all equipments on the contract. Testing equipment shall be made of durable material and shall be so dimensioned that gaged parts will be within specified tolerance. If tolerances are not specified, suitable tolerances shall be recommended by the contractor and submitted to the contracting officer for approval. Gages, jigs and templates shall be checked before initial inspection and at regular intervals thereafter, to insure that they have not become worn, maladjusted or otherwise made unsatisfactory for use.

*4.9 Guy load - Two guy assembly samples shall be tested of each diameter guy included in the contract or order. Each sample tested shall be proven capable of meeting the requirements of 3.12 when subjected to the tensile load shown by Table I Each sample shall include loops for an insulator, end terminations and one end of the sample shall be secured with clips as shown by the applicable USAECOM drawing. An insulator shall be installed in each sample during test, and the sample length shall conveniently fit into the test apparatus used. The test load shall be applied and measured by an approved tensile test machine. Samples shall be tested while attached to fixtures of the same diameter as the components attached to the guys during service.

*4 10 Strut load - Four samples of Strut G-8( ) shall demonstrate the ability to meet the requirements of paragraph 3.13 when tested in accordance with Figure 1.

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*4.11 Tower load.- One sample antenna support or tower assembly shall demonstrate the ability to meet the requirements of paragraph 3.14 when tested in the horizontal position. The sample shall have its base securely set on a surface perpendicular to its longitudinal axis. Test loads shall consist of a head load in accordance with paragraph 4.11.1 or 4.11.2, as applicable, and a simulated wind load. Wind load shall be simulated by placing or suspending weights along the sample equal to 180 pounds at five foot intervals. Observations shall be made during loading to detect any failure, and the sample shall be inspected following removal of the loads for permanent deformation of any member. The head load shall be measured by an approved device such as a dynamometer.

*4.11.1 Antenna Support AB-105( )/FRC.- One complete antenna support shall be tested. The head of the sample shall be supported by the back guy attached at an angle of 45 degrees ± 3 degrees to the horizontal axis of and directly above the antenna support. The head load shall be directed down through the center antenna attachment bracket. The test load shall be 13,000 pounds, simulating an 11,000 pound head load and a 2,000 pound guy load.

*4.11.2 Tower AB-127( )/FR.- One forty foot sample tower assembly including one base, one base erection assembly, two intermediate erection assemblies and one top erection assembly shall be tested. The head load shall be applied as a compressive load evenly distributed on the three tower legs at the forty foot level. The test head load shall be 14,900 pounds.

*4.12 Quality conformance inspection of preparation for delivery.- Preparation for delivery of Antenna Support AB-105( )/FRC or Tower AB-127( )/FR shall be inspected in accordance with Specification MIL-A-55613 or Specification MIL-T-14475 respectively.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

*5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing and marking shall be in accordance with the applicable provisions of Specification MIL-A-55613 for Antenna Support AB-105( )/FRC and Specification MIL-T-14475 for Tower AB-127( )/FR.

6 NOTES

*6.1 Intended use.- The towers covered by this specification are best suited for use at permanent or semipermanent installations.

*6.1.1 Antenna Support AB-105( )/FRC is used in groups of four to support rhombic antennas or in groups of two to support other horizontal antennas. It may also be used to support curtain type or omnidirectional antennas.

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*6.1.2 Tower AB-127( )/FR is a vertical radiator used as a long wave (low radio frequency) broadcast antenna. It may be used with radio sets operating in the broadcast band of frequencies (550 Kilohertz to 1,680 Kilohertz). When not operated as a direct radiator, it may be used to mount and support other radiating antennas.

*6.2 Ordering data -Procurement documents should specify the following·

(a) Title, number and date of this specification and any amendment thereto.

(b) Type required.

(c) Level of packaging and level of packing required for shipment. (Level A, Level B or Level C).

(d) Preproduction inspection:

(1) The following items are generally required for test purposes (See 3.3).

a. One complete antenna support in accordance with the contract or order or one assembled forty foot sample tower. (See 4.11.1 and 4.11.2)

b Four samples of strut G-8( ). (See 4.10)

c Two guy assembly samples of each diameter guy included in the contract or order. (See 4.9)

d. One welding sample. (See 4.7)

(e) Marking and shipping of samples.

(f) Place of final inspection.

(g) Technical literature required. (See 3.15)

(h) Quantity of tools and running spare parts required. (See 3.15)

*6.3 Group C inspection.- Approval to ship may be withheld, at the disrection of the Government, pending the decision from the contracting officer on the adequacy of corrective action (See 4.5.3.2)

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*6 4 Verification inspection.- Verification by the Government will be limited to the amount deemed necessary to determine compliance with the contract and will be limited in severity to the definitive quality assurance provisions established in this specification and the contract. The amount of verification inspection by the Government will be adjusted to make maximum utilization of the contractor's quality control system and the quality history of the product.

*6.5 Nomenclature.- The parentheses in the nomenclature will be deleted or replaced by a letter identifying the particular design, for example:
AB-105W/FRC. The contractor should apply for nomenclature in accordance with the applicable clause in the contract. (See 1.1)

*6 6 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

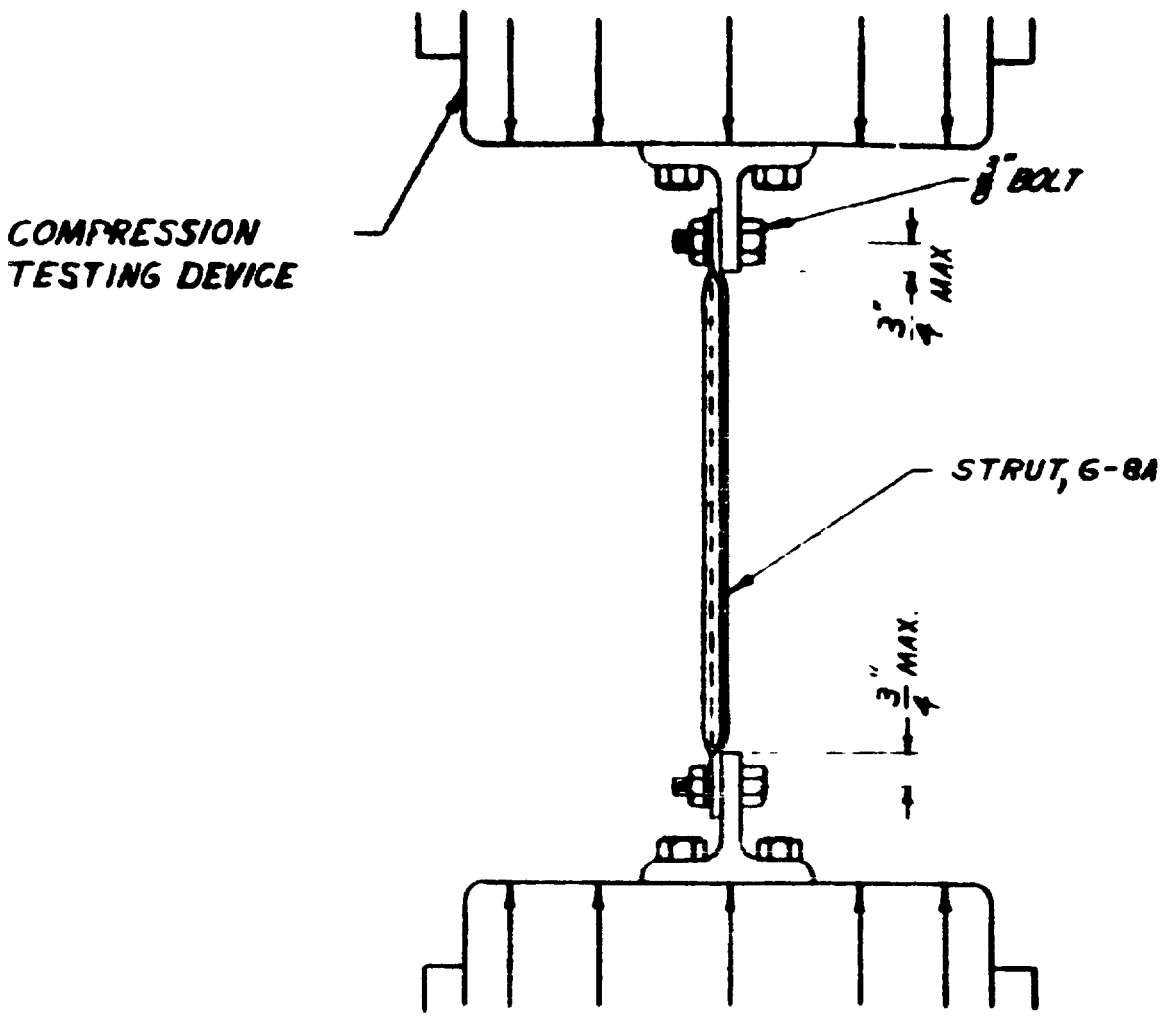
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DIAGONAL STRUT, G-8A, PER DRAWING SC-9-83024-1 SHALL BE MOUNTED AS SHOWN AND SHALL WITHSTAND A COMPRESSION LOAD OF 1,700 LB MIN

FIGURE 1 COMPRESSION TEST G-8A

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated Fold on lines on reverse side staple in corner and send to preparing activity Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements

SPECIFICATION

MIL-A-12868C(EL) ANTENNA SUPPORT AB-105( )/FRC TOWER AB-127( )/FR

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE	CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1 HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING

B RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2 COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3 IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4 REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*	DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 66 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64 WHICH MAY BE USED

ESC-FM 1068-68

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Fort Monmouth, New Jersey 07703

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